

Mason Walker

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EXPERIENCE

San Diego Gas & Electric

Data Scientist

San Diego, CA

2022 - Present

- **Design, implement and deploy machine learning models** including unsupervised clustering to segment 500k+ customers for targeted rate programs, time series forecasting for daily call volume prediction, and deploy interactive Marimo notebooks exploring EV adoption modeling.
- **Build automated data pipelines** leveraging AWS services (Glue, Athena, Lambda, Bedrock) to scrape and query data across multiple databases and apply large language models for text analysis projects helping to automate manual tasks.
- **Ensure data quality and statistical rigor** across survey projects; design sampling methodologies, create survey weights, and conduct statistical significance testing, calculate confidence intervals.
- **Drive technical excellence and standardization** across SDG&E's data science initiatives; define best practices for data science workflows, establish coding standards, and develop internal data science training programs and documentation as senior team member.
- **Mentor and train junior staff** on statistical methods, data science, and machine learning techniques.

Pew Research Center

Research Analyst I & II

Washington, D.C.

2020 - 2022

- **Developed survey sampling methodologies** including a 100k+ journalist sampling frame using automated web scraping techniques; designed and implemented data collection frameworks for nationwide surveys on media consumption and demographics.
- **Conducted advanced statistical analysis** on survey and observational data using R; built regression models, automated inter-coder reliability scripts, and performed significance testing to validate research findings.
- **Led cross-functional data projects** coordinating with Census Bureau and Bureau of Labor Statistics; integrated multiple government datasets to analyze employment trends, presented the findings to media industry stakeholders, and contributed to policy discussions.
- **Managed end-to-end data science projects** from design through delivery; supervised data coding workflows, created data visualizations and statistical summaries, and translated complex findings into accessible insights for lay audiences.
- **Published research findings** in high-impact reports and articles; authored multiple publications on media consumption trends, misinformation, and newsroom employment that were cited in major news outlets and referenced in congressional hearings.

Pew Research Center

Research Assistant I & II

Washington, D.C.

2017 - 2020

- **Lead research assistant** for international survey projects across Western Europe; developed data documentation and data pipelines to process multi-language survey data and generate standardized reports for cross-country comparisons.
- **Executed and designed qualitative research** managing 15 focus groups across 3 U.S. cities for year-long media perception study; analyzed transcripts using structured coding schemas and extracted actionable insights that informed subsequent survey design.
- **Coordinated flagship analytical publication** the annual State of the News Media Report; integrated audience metrics, economic datasets, and industry data from multiple data sources to create comprehensive market analysis reaching thousands of annual readers.
- **Oversaw quality assurance processes** for research operations including fact-checking protocols, data validation frameworks, and editorial workflows; trained and supervised junior staff on statistical analysis and data processing procedures.

EDUCATION

Northwestern University

Master of Science, Data Science

Evanston, IL

University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Arts, Political Science

Santa Barbara, CA

SKILLS

Languages: Python, R, SQL (SQLite, PostgreSQL), Cypher

Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Tidyverse, XGBoost, Tidymodels, Hugging Face, ggplot2, Plotly

Tools: AWS (S3, EC2, Lambda, Glue, Bedrock, SageMaker, Athena), GitHub, Linux, Chalice, LangChain, CloudWatch, SAP, Marimo, DataBricks

Data Science: Clustering, Predictive Modeling, Time Series (Prophet, ARIMA), A/B Testing, Causal Inference, NLP

PUBLICATIONS

["Nearly a quarter of Americans get news from podcasts"](#) Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2022.

["News consumption across social media in 2021"](#) Walker & Matsa. *Pew Research Center*, 2021.

["More Americans now say government should take steps to restrict false information online than in 2018"](#) Mitchell & Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2021.

["U.S. newsroom employment has fallen 26% since 2008"](#) Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2021.

["A third of large U.S. newspapers experienced layoffs in 2020, more than in 2019"](#) Walker & Matsa. *Pew Research Center*, 2021.

["Nearly 2,800 newspaper companies received paycheck protection loans, and most were under \\$150K"](#) Walker & Matsa. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["Americans blame unfair news coverage on media outlets, not the journalists who work for them"](#) Walker & Gottfried. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["Most Americans see a place for anonymous sources in news stories, but not all the time"](#) Gottfried & Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["Americans see skepticism of news media as healthy, say public trust in the institution can improve"](#) Gottfried, Walker, Mitchell. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["Americans' views of the news media during the COVID-19 outbreak"](#) Gottfried, Walker, Mitchell. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["U.S. media polarization and the 2020 election: A nation divided"](#) Jurkowitz, Mitchell, Shearer, Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2020.

["Trusting the news media in the Trump era"](#) Gottfried, Stocking, Grieco, Walker, Khuzam, Mitchell. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Americans favor mobile devices over desktops and laptops for getting news"](#) Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Who pays for local news in the U.S.?"](#) Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Republicans far more likely than Democrats to say fact-checkers tend to favor one side"](#) Walker & Gottfried. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Many Americans say made-up news is a critical problem that needs to be fixed"](#) Mitchell, Gottfried, Stocking, Walker, Fedeli. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Many Americans say made-up news is a critical problem that needs to be fixed"](#) Mitchell, Gottfried, Stocking, Walker, Fedeli. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["News media attitudes in France"](#) Sumida, Walker, Mitchell. *Pew Research Center*, 2019.

["Western Europeans under 30 view news media less positively, rely more on digital platforms than older adults"](#) Matsa, Silver, Shearer, Walker. *Pew Research Center*, 2018.

["In Western Europe, public attitudes toward news media more divided by populist views than left-right ideology"](#) Mitchell, Simmons, Matsa Silver, Shearer, Johnson, Walker, Taylor. *Pew Research Center*, 2018.

PRESENTATIONS

JupyterCon, San Diego, CA, "Driving Equity in San Diego: Linking Census Demographics and EV Access", November 4, 2025

The League of Women Voters of Nebraska, "Literacy in an Age of Disinformation", November 4, 2021

American Association of Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) Annual Conference, Media Attitudes Session, "Studying How Media Habits and Attitudes Relate to Perceptions of the 2020 Election: A Year-Long Survey Series", June 12, 2020

American Association of Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) Annual Conference Poster Session, Toronto, Canada, "Comparing Estimates of Newsroom Employees in U.S. Government and Private-Sector Surveys", May 18, 2019